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▶ GDP GROWTH

SO FAR, SO GOOD

India's GDP growth beats forecasts in the first quarter of FY27, showing surprising resilience despite geopolitical headwinds. But some experts question the high numbers

By M.G. ARUN

INDIA'S ECONOMY HAS DELIVERED A STRONGER PERFORMANCE than many expected, with the latest data offering a reassuring picture of its resilience in a turbulent global environment. Gross Domestic Product (GDP)—the standard measure of the size and growth of an economy—expanded 7.8 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) in the April-June quarter (Q1FY27), compared with 6.9 per cent in the same quarter a year earlier (Q1FY26). The figure, released by the ministry of statistics and programme implementation (MoSPI) on August 31, is well ahead of analysts' forecasts and the Reserve Bank of India's own projection of 7 per cent.

The growth is particularly significant because it came in the first full quarter since the Iran war, as the global economy absorbed the shock of higher energy prices and continuing tensions in West Asia. Meanwhile, nominal GDP, measured at current

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS**